

Unit: Achilles' Heel

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Lead-in Examples / 導入範例

1. Mathematics has always been my Achilles' heel.

1. 數學一直是我的致命傷（阿基里斯之踵）。

2. The team's offense is their Achilles' heel.

2. 該隊的進攻是他們的致命弱點。

3. Marketing traditionally has been an Achilles' heel for phone companies because of their monopoly mind-set.

3. 營銷傳統上一直是電話公司的致命弱點，因為他們的壟斷心態。

Meaning & Origin / 語義與起源

Meaning / 片語含義

A small problem or weakness in a person or system that can result in failure. (Cambridge Online Dictionary)

一個人或系統中可能導致失敗的小問題或弱點。（《劍橋線上詞典》）

Origin in Greek Mythology / 神話起源

The common phrase “Achilles’ heel” comes from ancient Greek mythology. Thetis, one of daughters of the sea god Nereus, was married to Peleus (King of the Thessaly) and gave birth to Achilles. Making Achilles invulnerable, intelligent and brave, Thetis dipped him into the River Styx as a baby. However, a part of his body did not immerse in the water, namely heel, because it was held by his mother. As a result, his heel remained unprotected. In Trojan war, Paris, prince of Troy, guided by Apollo and shot an arrow which pierced Achilles’ heel. After that, Achilles was mortally wounded and died in the war.

常見片語「阿基里斯之踵」源於古希臘神話。海神涅柔斯的女兒之一忒提斯嫁給了佩琉斯（色薩利國王）並生下了阿基里斯。為了讓阿基里斯刀槍不入、聰明勇敢，忒提斯在他嬰兒時將他浸入冥河（River Styx）中。然而，他身體的一個部分沒有浸入水中，即腳踝（腳跟），因為它被他的母親握著。結果，他的腳跟仍然沒有受到保護。在特洛伊戰爭中，特洛伊王子帕里斯在阿波羅的指引下射出了一支箭，刺穿了阿基里斯的腳跟。在此之後，阿基里斯受了致命傷並在戰爭中死去。

Actually, the phrase Achilles’ heel was not used in English until 19th century. It was used as a metaphor for vulnerability in an essay named The Friend; a literary, moral and political weekly paper, which was written by Samuel Taylor Coleridge in 1810. He wrote “Ireland, that vulnerable heel of the British Achilles!” That was how the connection was established. Furthermore, the tendon at the back of human heel was even named the Achilles' tendon as a medical term. To sum up, Greek mythology has a great influence on English expressions.

事實上，「阿基里斯之踵」這個片語直到 19 世紀才在英語中使用。它被用作脆弱性的隱喻，出現在山繆·泰勒·柯勒律治於 1810 年撰寫的散文《朋友；文學、道德和政治週刊》中。他寫道：「愛爾蘭，英國阿基里斯那脆弱的腳跟！」這就是這種聯

繫的建立方式。此外，人體腳踝後面的肌腱甚至在醫學術語中被命名為「阿基里斯腱」。總之，希臘神話對英語表達有著巨大的影響。

Extended Content / 延伸內容

Achilles in Philosophy (Zeno's Paradox) / 哲學中的阿基里斯 (芝諾悖論)

Do you know Achilles also plays an interesting role in Philosophy? Have you heard of Zeno's paradox? Even though Achilles is a hero and runs fast in Greek mythology, he could never outrun a tortoise. A paradox is a situation or statement that seems impossible or is difficult to understand because it contains two opposite facts or characteristics. (Cambridge Online Dictionary) This particular paradox about Achilles looks into the paradoxes of motion. Let us assume: Achilles is in a footrace with a tortoise and he allows the tortoise a run 100 meters before he starts. Since this is an English class, not philosophy, we are going to jump to the conclusion: Achilles will never catch up with the tortoise. Isn't this fascinating? For those who are interested in how it came to this conclusion, please discuss this in the discussion forum. Meanwhile, if you take one of the new philosophical courses regarding paradoxes in the Department of Humanities, you will learn about this to a great extent.

學長，你知道阿基里斯在哲學中也扮演著有趣的角色嗎？你聽說過芝諾悖論嗎？儘管阿基里斯是一位英雄，並且在希臘神話中跑得很快，但他永遠無法超越一隻烏龜。悖論是指一種看似不可能或難以理解的情況或陳述，因為它包含兩個相反的事實或特徵。（《劍橋線上詞典》）這個關於阿基里斯的特殊悖論研究了運動的悖論。讓我們假設：阿基里斯與烏龜進行一場跑步比賽，他在開始之前允許烏龜先跑 100 米。既然這是英語課，而不是哲學課，我們將跳到結論：阿基里斯永遠追不上烏龜。這不是很迷人嗎？對於那些對它是如何得出這個結論感興趣的人，請在討論區進行討論。同時，如果您選修人文學部關於悖論的新哲學課程之一，您將在很大程度上學習到這一點。

The River Styx / 冥河

According to Greek mythology, Styx was one of rivers that formed the boundary between Earth and the Underworld. There was a ferryman called Charon, who took responsibility for transporting souls of the newly dead to the Underworld. In order to cross the river, dead people must pay the fee to Charon, or they would be left to wander for one hundred years. Moreover, Styx was also known as a goddess in charge of the River Styx. The river had miraculous powers to make someone dipped into the river invulnerable. Achilles was the most famous one from mythology.

根據希臘神話，冥河是形成地球與冥界邊界的河流之一。有一位叫卡倫的船夫，他負責將新死者的靈魂運送到冥界。為了過河，死者必須向卡倫支付費用，否則他們將被留下徘徊一百年。此外，Styx 也被稱為掌管冥河的女神。這條河具有神奇的力量，可以使浸入河中的人刀槍不入。阿基里斯是神話中最著名的一個。

The Judgement of Paris / 帕里斯的評判

Eris, a goddess of strife and discord, bore a grudge against Peleus and Thetis because she was not invited to attend their wedding reception. Therefore, she tossed a golden apple inscribed "for the most beautiful one" into the party. The goddesses Hera, Athena and Aphrodite had a bitter quarrel about the appropriate recipient, and they asked Zeus to make the decision. However, Zeus passed the buck to the prince of Troy, Paris. He was appointed to select a goddess who is the most beautiful. As a result, the goddesses were seeking the judgement of Paris through bribes, offering political power by Hera, promising infinite wisdom by Athena, and tempting with the most beautiful woman in the world by Aphrodite. After some consideration, he decided to award Aphrodite the golden apple, thereby causing Trojan war which centered around the most beautiful woman in the world, Helen. Thus, the judgement of Paris was considered to be the main event leading up to the war.

紛爭與不和女神艾莉絲對佩琉斯和忒提斯心存怨恨，因為她沒有被邀請參加他們的婚禮。因此，她在派對上扔下了一個刻有「給最美麗的女性」的金蘋果。女神赫拉、雅典娜和阿芙蘿黛蒂為合適的接受者發生了激烈的爭吵，她們要求宙斯做出決定。然而，宙斯將這個責任推給了特洛伊王子帕里斯。他被任命選出一位最美麗的女神。結果，女神們通過賄賂尋求帕里斯的評判，赫拉提供政治權力，雅典娜承諾無限的智慧，而阿芙蘿黛蒂則以世界上最美麗的女性來誘惑他。經過一番考量，他決定將金蘋果授予阿芙蘿黛蒂，從而引發了圍繞世界上最美麗的女性海倫展開的特洛伊戰爭。因此，帕里斯的評判被認為是導致戰爭的主要事件。